FAMILY DEVOTIONS FOR THE WEEK

Faith Formation for Families • The Congregation at Prayer • Week of August 16–22, 2026

Season of Pentecost ✠ Liturgical Color: Green

Invocation
In the name of the Father and of the ✠ Son and of the Holy Spirit. Amen.

Introit (see back page)

Memory Verse for the Week — Titus 3:4–6
"When the goodness and loving kindness of God our Savior appeared, He saved us, not because of works done by us in righteousness, but according to His own mercy, by the washing of regeneration and renewal of the Holy Spirit, whom He poured out on us richly through Jesus Christ our Savior."

Daily Readings: LSB p. 299

Sun: 2 Samuel 6:1–19; 1 Corinthians 9:1–23
Mon: 2 Samuel 7:1–17; 1 Corinthians 9:24–10:22
Tue: 2 Samuel 7:18–29; 1 Corinthians 10:23–11:16
Wed: 2 Samuel 11:1–27; 1 Corinthians 11:17–34
Thu: 2 Samuel 12:1–25; 1 Corinthians 12:1–13
Fri: 1 Kings 1:1–4, 15–35; 1 Corinthians 12:14–31
Sat: 1 Kings 2:1–27; 1 Corinthians 13:1–13

Talk About It This Week
Each day, read the appointed readings (or just one), then ask: *Where did we hear God's Word planted today? What is God teaching us to trust?* Day-by-day questions for younger and older children are in the daily devotion pages (and on the web page).

In Our Prayers This Week (LSB Daily Prayer Themes)
✠ **Sun:** the joy of the resurrection; fruit of faith in all who heard the Word today
✠ **Mon:** our Baptism, callings, and daily work; schools; good government and peace
✠ **Tues:** deliverance from temptation and evil; the addicted and despairing
✠ **Wed:** marriage and family; parents and children; our home and community
✠ **Thurs:** the Church, pastors, teachers, and missionaries; thanksgiving for the Sacrament
✠ **Fri:** the preaching of the cross; the persecuted; the sick and the dying
✠ **Sat:** faithfulness to the end; hearts made ready for the Lord's Day

Hymn of the Week: "In Christ There Is No East or West" — LSB 653
In Christ there is no East or West, / In Him no South or North, / But one great fellowship of love / Throughout the whole wide earth.

Apostles' Creed

Lord's Prayer

Benediction
Let us bless the Lord. **Thanks be to God.**

HOW TO USE THIS PAGE… Gather once a day — at breakfast, supper, or bedtime. Speak the Invocation, say the memory verse together, read the day's readings, talk about them, sing the hymn stanza, pray for the day's theme, and close with the Lord's Prayer and Benediction. Ten minutes is plenty. The seed does the work — "so shall My word be… it shall not return to Me empty" (Isaiah 55:11).

The Twelfth Sunday after Pentecost (Proper 15) August 16, 2026

Season of Pentecost ✠ Liturgical Color: Green

Introit *Psalm 28:1–2, 6–7; antiphon: v. 8*

The LORD is the strength of his people;
he is the saving refuge of his anointed.

To you, O LORD, I call; my rock, be not deaf to me,
lest, if you be silent to me, I become like those who go down to the pit.
Hear the voice of my pleas for mercy, when I cry to you for help,
when I lift up my hands toward your most holy sanctuary.
Blessed be the LORD!
For he has heard the voice of my pleas for mercy.
The LORD is my strength and my shield; in him my heart trusts, and I am helped;
my heart exults, and with my song I give thanks to him.
Glory be to the Father and to the Son and to the Holy Spirit;
as it was in the beginning, is now, and will be forever. Amen.

The LORD is the strength of his people;
he is the saving refuge of his anointed.

Collect of the Day

Almighty God, whom to know is everlasting life, grant us to know Your Son, Jesus, to be the way, the truth, and the life, that we may steadfastly follow His steps in the way that leads to life eternal; through Jesus Christ, our Lord, who lives and reigns with You and the Holy Spirit, one God, now and forever. Amen.

This Sunday's Readings

Isaiah 56:1, 6–8 · Psalm 67 · Romans 11:1–2a, 13–15, 28–32 · Matthew 15:21–28

Gradual *Psalm 34:9, 19*

Oh, fear the LORD, you his saints,
for those who fear him have no lack!
Many are the afflictions of the righteous,
but the LORD delivers him out of them all.

Next Sunday's Readings (Proper 16)

Isaiah 51:1–6 · Psalm 138 · Romans 11:33–12:8 · Matthew 16:13–20

Learn by Heart: The First Commandment *LSB p. 321*

"You shall have no other gods. What does this mean? We should fear, love, and trust in God above all things."

THIS WEEK AT HOME: In this Sunday's Gospel, a Canaanite woman will not stop crying out to Jesus for mercy, and He commends her: "Woman, great is your faith!" Isaiah promises that God's house will be "a house of prayer for all peoples," and Paul wrestles with how mercy reaches both Jew and Gentile. Through the week, watch David's house rise and then crack under his own sin, while Paul tells the Corinthians that even the strongest believer needs humility and love for the weak. Ask one another: "Where do we need the Canaanite woman's bold, persistent faith this week?"

Kids in the Divine Service — What is the "Kyrie"?

The Kyrie comes from the Greek words "kyrie eleison" (pronounced KEER-ee-ay eh-LAY-zon), which means "Lord, have mercy." We sing it after we have confessed our sins and received God's forgiveness.

When we sing the Kyrie, we are crying out for mercy so God would hear us and help us in every time of need. This week's Gospel gives us that very cry: the Canaanite woman calls out, "Lord, have mercy on me!" — the Kyrie in a single voice.

Parents: *During worship, help your children recognize the Kyrie and its place in the service. Practice saying "Kyrie eleison" together, and praise them for learning a bit of Greek!*

Scripture quotations are from the ESV® Bible, © 2001 by Crossway. Introit, Collect, and Gradual from Lutheran Service Book, © 2006 Concordia Publishing House. "KIDS in the Divine Service" © 2017 LCMS Worship, created by Christopher Thoma; LCMS congregations have permission to reproduce for their use.